A KEEPSAKE FROM YALE'S MUSEUMS

My Yale Museum Keepsake

Chosen by Anjali

October 25, 2026







Yale Morris Steinert Collection of Musical Instruments · Yale University Library · Yale Peabody Museum · Yale Center for British Art · Yale Campus Art



1

Violin, 1/2 size

Gennaro Gagliano (Italian), ca. 1760

A small violin with a figured back

Gennaro Gagliano, an Italian maker, made this half-size violin around 1760. Its back is formed from two pieces of quarter-sawn wood, whose figure runs almost horizontally and slopes just slightly downward from the center. The violin measures 51.1 centimetres overall, with a body length of 30 centimetres. It belongs to the Yale Morris Steinert Collection of Musical Instruments and was given by Hugh W. Long as part of the Emil Herrmann Collection.

Look closer: Look for the nearly horizontal figure in the two-piece wooden back, dipping slightly from the center.

Overall length: 51.1 cm, Length of body: 30.0 cm, Width of upper bout: 13.8 cm, Width of middle bout: 9.3 cm, Width of lower bout: 17.7 cm, Height of ribs: 2.8 cm, Vibrating length of strings: 27.8 cm

Yale Morris Steinert Collection of Musical Instruments · 4719.1962
Emil Herrmann Collection, Gift of Hugh W. Long
Image: Yale Morris Steinert Collection of Musical Instruments, No Copyright - United States



2

Taste a-la-mode, 1745 [graphic]

Francis Patton, Louis-Philippe Boitard, publish'd according to act of Parliament, Septr. 12th, 1745.

Fashion on parade in St James's Park

Francis Patton made this print after an image by Louis-Philippe Boitard, an artist active from 1733 to 1770. Published on September 12, 1745, it presents a satire on fashion: a crowd gathers in St James's Park in front of Buckingham House. At the centre, a woman wears a large hooped skirt and a lace cap, while other fashionable figures fill the scene. The print measures 23 by 33 centimetres.

Look closer: At the centre, notice the woman's large hooped skirt, lace cap, and black lace mittens.

1 print : sheet 23 x 33 cm

Yale University Library, Lewis Walpole Library · 745.09.12.01+
Image: Yale University Library, public domain (made before 1900), used under Yale's Open Access policy



3

Oboe

Thomas Cahusac Sr. (English), ca. 1750

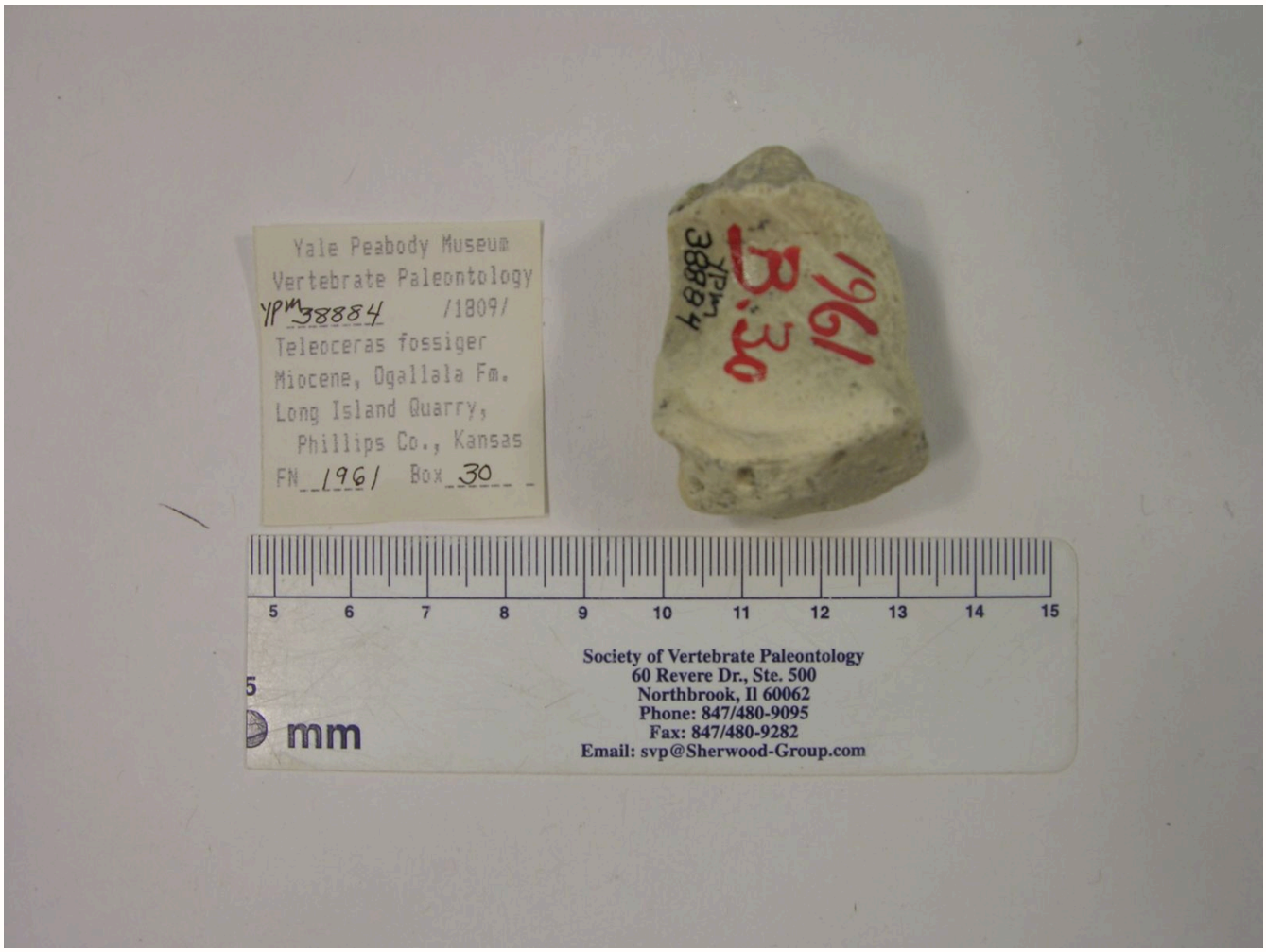
Ivory rings and a swallowtail key

The English maker Thomas Cahusac Sr. made this oboe around 1750. It comes apart into three pieces, joined with ivory rings, and has two circular brass keys, one shaped like a swallowtail. Its overall length is 58.4 cm. The instrument belongs to the Yale Morris Steinert Collection of Musical Instruments.

Look closer: Notice the swallowtailed shape of one of the two circular brass keys.

Overall length: 58.4 cm

Yale Morris Steinert Collection of Musical Instruments · 3425.2002
Associates Fund
Image: Yale Morris Steinert Collection of Musical Instruments, No Copyright - United States



4

Teleoceras fossiger

Collected by John Bell Hatcher, Yale Hatcher 1884-85 Long Island Expedition, 1885-03-30 to 1885-10-04

A small clue in a fossil bone

This fossil is a right trapezoid bone from Teleoceras fossiger, which the museum places among the rhinoceroses and odd-toed ungulates. John Bell Hatcher collected it between March 30 and October 4, 1885, during the Yale Hatcher 1884-85 Long Island Expedition. It is now part of the Vertebrate Paleontology collection at the Yale Peabody Museum.

Yale Peabody Museum, Vertebrate Paleontology · YPM VP 038884
Image: Yale Peabody Museum, CC0



5

Tablet. Personal guarantee. Neo-Babylonian. Clay. Witnessed.

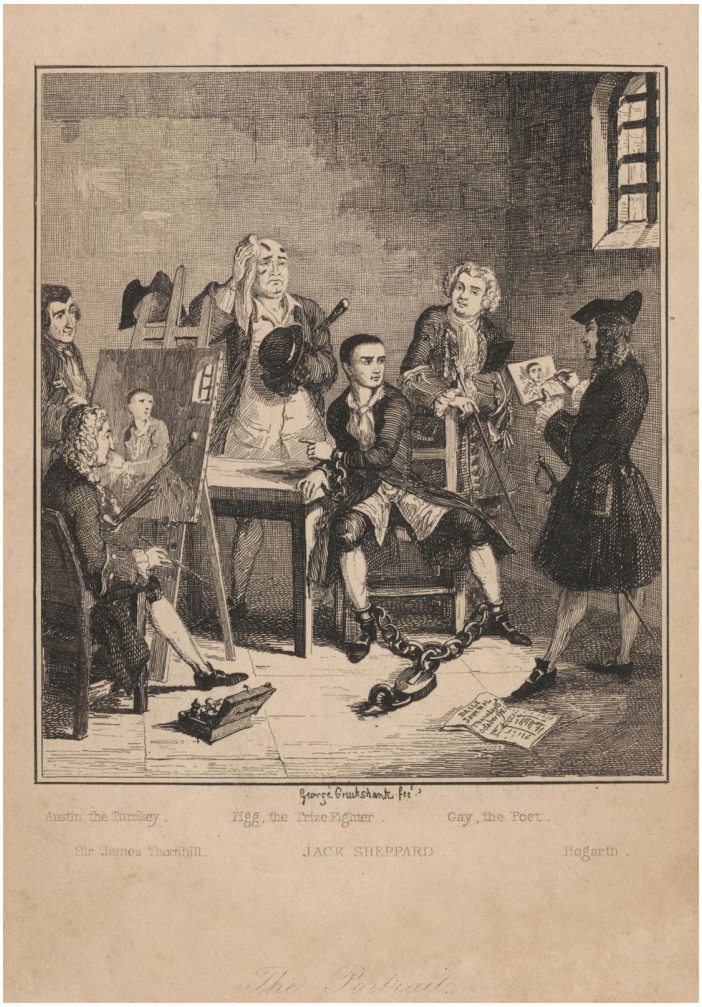
A witnessed promise in clay

This small clay tablet is titled “Personal guarantee” and identified as Neo-Babylonian. The museum’s note describes it as an archival item connected with a legal transaction and high officials, and records it as witnessed. It measures 39 millimetres high, 51 millimetres wide, and 19 millimetres thick. The tablet is part of the Babylonian collection at the Yale Peabody Museum.

Look closer: Notice the tablet’s compact rectangular form, recorded as clay.

clay. height 39.0 mm, width 51.0 mm, thickness 19.0 mm

Yale Peabody Museum, Babylonian · YPM BC 023277
Image: Yale Peabody Museum, CC0



6

The Portrait

George Cruikshank, 1836

A portrait etched on cream paper

George Cruikshank made this print, titled The Portrait, in 1836. It is an etching on medium, slightly textured, cream wove paper. The sheet measures 7 1/4 × 10 1/8 inches (18.4 × 25.7 cm). The work belongs to the Prints and Drawings department at the Yale Center for British Art.

Etching on medium, slightly textured, cream wove paper. Sheet: 7 1/4 × 10 1/8 inches (18.4 × 25.7 cm)

Yale Center for British Art, Prints and Drawings · B1998.14.109
Yale Center for British Art; Yale University Art Gallery Collection
Image: Yale Center for British Art, CC0



Your photo, taken at Yale Campus Art

7

Dean Liston Pope

Mark Potter (American, 1929–1995), 1960

A square portrait in oil

Mark Potter, an American artist, painted this portrait of Dean Liston Pope in 1960. Made in oil on masonite, it measures 48 by 48¼ inches. Its square format gives the portrait a compact, balanced shape. The work is part of Yale Campus Art and came by transfer from the Yale University Art Gallery, as a gift of alumni to the Divinity School.

Oil on masonite. 48 × 48 1/4 in. (121.9 × 122.6 cm)

Yale Campus Art · CAC1960.14
Transfer from the Yale University Art Gallery, Gift of alumni to the Divinity School
Image: your own photo, for personal use. The museum's image isn't cleared for reuse (Not assigned).

About this book

The objects, their details and their photographs come from the collections of Yale Morris Steinert Collection of Musical Instruments, Yale University Library, Yale Peabody Museum, Yale Center for British Art, and Yale Campus Art, through Yale's LUX collections platform (lux.collections.yale.edu).

Photographs are included only where the museum marks them public domain or CC0, or, for Yale University Library objects made before 1900, under Yale's Open Access policy for works in the public domain (guides.library.yale.edu/openaccess). Where the museum's image isn't cleared, the page shows the visitor's own photo, marked "Your photo", or a link to the museum's own page.

Each description was written by an AI model (gpt-6-luna) using only the museum's own records for that object, then checked so that every date, number and name appears in those records. Where the AI text wasn't available, the page shows the museum's details instead.

Made with Yale Museum Keepsake, October 25, 2026.